FREE KIT · AFFILIATE MARKETING

FREE KIT

Your trust is the product. Recommend like it.

How affiliate links actually work, the honest filter for choosing what to recommend, and where the clicks come from without an audience.

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How affiliate links work

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The three-question filter

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Clicks without an audience

01

How links, cookies and disclosure work

You recommend someone else's product through a tracked link. The company handles the product, the checkout and the payment. Your job is the honest recommendation.

The link

A normal link with a tracking code attached. When someone clicks and buys, the code tells the company you sent them.

The program

Where you get the link. Free to join, in almost every case.

The cookie

A window that often credits you even if she buys a few days after clicking.

The commission

A set percentage or flat fee from the company. The buyer pays nothing extra.

Disclosure isn't optional. One line, "some links here are affiliate links, which means I may earn a small commission at no cost to you," is legally required in most places. And it builds trust.

02

The three-question filter

Every recommendation is a tiny deposit or withdrawal on your credibility. The link monetises trust you've already built. Recommend something great and she trusts you more next time. Recommend for the payout and she stops believing you. You can't out-volume a trust problem. So before any link goes in, ask these three, in this order.

1. Do I use it?

Genuinely, and would I stand behind it for free?

2. Does she need it?

Does it solve a real problem for my reader?

3. Is the pay fair?

Only now. The commission is a tiebreaker, never the deciding vote.

The final check

Would I still tell her to buy this with no commission at all? If not, the link doesn't go in.

The common mistake: chasing the highest-commission program, or the famous one, instead of the most honest pick. A tool you love can be recommended with a straight face a hundred times. One you don't believe in, once.

Be a friend with taste, not a billboard. A friend says "get this one, skip that one, and here's why." A billboard shouts at everyone. Only one of those gets a click from a reader who comes back.

Recommend only what you'd recommend for free. The commission is the bonus, never the reason.

03

Where the clicks come from without an audience

Someone types "best tool for X" into Pinterest or Google. She lands on your genuinely useful comparison and clicks your link because you answered her question well. You don't need a following. You need to be found at the moment she's deciding.

Five tools I'd recommend even if nobody paid me:
[tool 1] **[tool 2]** **[tool 3]** **[tool 4]** **[tool 5]**

Which of them have an affiliate program: **[check each one]**

The question my reader is already searching: **[e.g. best design tool for beginners]**

My honest answer, and why: **[get this one, skip that one, here's why]**

1. List your five before you look at any payout. That keeps you honest by design.
2. Write one helpful post or pin that answers the searched question.
3. Place your honest recommendation and link inside it, with your disclosure line.

WRITE IT ONCE

Put the recommendation inside evergreen content → it keeps surfacing in search → new readers find the same answer → the recommendation you wrote once keeps working while you sleep.

A warning sign: reputable affiliate programs are free to join. If one asks you to pay to become an affiliate, walk away.